Q. But the BJP points to Indira Gandhi's Congress government and the 1975 Emergency...

This propaganda has been happening for over four decades. Indira Gandhi admitted it was a mistake. The Modi government is doing worse, chief ministers are being arrested now. During the Emergency, only the agitators were arrested. Where is the governance now...there is only whipping. If you don't follow orders, you are harassed.

Q. The BJP also charges the Congress-led UPA government of being extremely corrupt, says that is why they lost power in 2014...

The BJP levelled so many corruption charges against the UPA government. What happened to the so-called 2G scam and coal scam? Nothing was proved against us. Based on the CAG report, they made a mountain out of a molehill. The prime minister keeps abusing the Gandhi family. No member of the Gandhi family has been in power since 1989. They never misused any authority. Yet he keeps humiliating the family. Why? Because he is afraid of the Gandhi family. Sonia Gandhi rarely speaks. Yet, the people take her seriously. Modi barks every day. Nobody takes him seriously. He is on campaign mode all the time. Have you ever seen a prime minister who keeps campaigning for elections, right from zilla panchayat to Lok Sabha? He is always at rallies, never at his office. He never applies his mind, that's why he takes wrong decisions. His motto is election, not development.

Q. Where do you see the Congress performance improving? In the past two elections, in nearly 200 seats where the Congress and the BJP went head-to-head, the latter won over 90 per cent of the seats.

Nearly two-third of the states were once under the control of non-BJP parties. Wherever the Congress or BJP's rivals won, he put pressure on the government. People have seen how our governments were broken in Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh, Goa and Manipur. The Rajasthan government narrowly survived. Now, he is after us in Himachal Pradesh. He doesn't release central funds, doesn't provide assistance during natural disasters. The PM has built this fake perception that only he can deliver. He also had the backing of the RSS who thought Modi would complete their agenda. Just before the elections, he exploits emotional issues such as Pulwama or polarises voters on communal lines. Under these circumstances, people don't vote based on ideology or performance record. Modi is not going to voters with his development record because there is none. He is saying: "If you want Ram, vote for me." However, the Congress and our alliance partners are working hard. We are contesting elections unitedly in at least 80 per cent seats. I.N.D.I.A. will get a working majority in this election. The undercurrents will hit Modi hard this time.

Q. Political analysts say the Ram temple in Ayodhya could become a major issue this Lok Sabha election.

> "MODI KEEPS CALLING THE CONGRESS CORRUPT. HE SAYS HE WANTS TO END CORRUPTION. BUT HE HAS THE CORRUPT SIT NEXT TO HIM. HE SAYS THE CORRUPT WILL NOT BE SPARED. BUT THEY GET SPARED IF THEY SHAKE HANDS WITH HIM"



> "THE PM KEEPS ABUSING THE GANDHI FAMILY. NO MEMBER OF THE GANDHI FAMILY HAS BEEN IN POWER SINCE 1989. THEY NEVER MISUSED ANY AUTHORITY, YET MODI KEEPS HUMILIATING THE FAMILY. WHY? BECAUSE HE IS AFRAID OF THE GANDHI FAMILY"